

An Indian Ghost.

The most weird story we have heard is told by two well-known men of this place, who were on a prospecting tour some three weeks since, near Cobblestone mountain, at the northern boundary of this county. One cold night they were simultaneously awakened about 2 o'clock by the noise of crackling brush that had been thrown on the fire. They arose to a sitting posture and saw the figure of an Indian woman standing by the fire. She was dressed in a robe of gayly colored material that nearly reached her feet. A glistening necklace, evidently of gold and silver, enriched her neck, and hanging pendant from this was a number of bears' claws. Her black hair reached below her waist. In her ears were large hoop earrings of gold.

Upon seeing the form one of the young men instinctively reached for his rifle by his side. When the figure saw the motion she motioned for him not to fire and moved down the trail, beckoning to them. Before disappearing from view she again beckoned, but they were too dumbfounded to follow. The next morning they followed the trail, and after much difficulty traced the footprints to the base of a high cliff about a mile from their camp. The rest of the story told is to this effect: "The next morning we discussed the matter and determined to investigate. So the next night we took our blankets and went to the base of the cliff. At about midnight, the same hour, the figure appeared to us; we saw a bright phosphorescent light on the brow of the cliff, and I am sure we heard a voice calling, 'Meeneeah! Meeneeah!'"

An old Indian tradition is to the effect that many, many years ago an Indian maiden—Meeneeah, the only daughter of a chief—was lost in this region and starved to death near the place called Squaw Flat. It is said that many camping parties have seen the phosphorescent light spoken of in the vicinity where these young men were camped. [Ventura (Cal.) Free Press.

Boonily may indeed be derived from the